

WEEK 2 · DAY 1

Write a Prompt for a 7-Day Meal Plan

Assignment | learn. build. operate

1. Problem Statement

Write a **reusable prompt**, not a one-off question, that produces a healthy **7-day vegetarian South Indian meal plan** for someone working towards weight loss. The gap between "give me a diet plan" and a prompt that works every time is everything you put around it: who the AI is, who it is writing for, what is allowed, and exactly how the answer must be laid out.

Tools: Any AI chat tool, a text editor

2. Requirements

- Save your finished prompt in a file named `meal_plan_prompt.md`.
- The prompt must set a **role**, describe **who the plan is for**, and list the **constraints**.
- Vegetarian and recognisably **South Indian**, name real dishes, not "a healthy breakfast".
- Cover all **7 days** with breakfast, lunch, a snack and dinner.
- Pin down the **output format**: a day-by-day table with portion sizes, so every run looks the same.
- Build in sensible guardrails, balanced meals, ordinary portions, **no extreme restriction**, and ingredients actually available locally.
- Make it **reusable**: put the changeable details (activity level, allergies, dislikes) in one block at the top that someone can edit without rewriting the prompt.

Think it through

A vague prompt gets a vague plan. What does the AI still not know, how much time there is to cook on a weekday, who else eats at the table, what is actually in season? And decide what should **not** appear: a plan built on quinoa and avocado is not a South Indian plan, however healthy it looks.

This is a prompt-writing exercise. Whatever the model produces is a draft to think about, not dietary advice; a real plan belongs with a qualified dietitian.

3. Steps to complete

These are hints, not the full answer. The work is in the rewriting, not the first draft.

Step 1: Draft the structure first

Write the skeleton before you write a word of content. Each block does a different job.

```
# ROLE      who the AI is writing as
# FOR       age, activity level, allergies, dislikes  <- editable block
# CONSTRAINTS  vegetarian, South Indian, local ingredients,
              balanced portions, no extreme restriction
# PLAN      7 days x breakfast / lunch / snack / dinner
# FORMAT     one table, columns: Day | Meal | Dish | Portion
# AVOID      ingredients and framing you do not want
```

Step 2: Run it and find the holes

Run the prompt once and read the output as if a stranger wrote it. Where is it vague, where has it guessed, and where did it ignore you? Every one of those is a line you are missing.

Step 3: Tighten and prove it is reusable

Fix what the first run exposed, then change only the **FOR** block (a different activity level, or a nut allergy) and run again. If the structure holds and only the dishes change, your prompt works.

4. Final output

```
| Day | Meal      | Dish                                | Portion  |
| Mon | Breakfast | Idli with sambar                    | 3 idli   |
| Mon | Lunch     | Rice, kootu, beans poriyal         | 1 cup ...|
| Mon | Snack     | ...                                | ...      |
...through all 7 days
```

5. What to submit

- Your meal_plan_prompt.md file, pushed to **GitHub**, link shared in **WhatsApp**.
- Screenshots of **two** runs from the same prompt with different FOR blocks.
- Two or three lines on what you changed after the first run and why.